the country for a year, visiting Buddhist pilgrimage places, including the Mahabodhi temple at Bodh Gaya and ancient shrines in Rajgir, including the Gridhkuta hill. Memorial stones with inscriptions were left behind by the mission at the Mahabodhi temple and on Gridhkuta hill, but these do not exist any longer. It is from the Chinese sources that we know what the inscriptions said. They express awe and spiritual sentiment on the part of the Chinese visitors at seeing places associated with Lord Buddha, but also words in praise of the Tang emperor. A rubbing of an imprint of the Buddha's foot was made by a member of the delegation, Wang Xuance, who later led the final mission to India in 647 CE . A copy of the rubbing found its way to Japan, where it is preserved in the Yakushiji temple in Nara. What is more interesting is that the second mission was also charged by the Tang emperor to obtain the Indian method of making crystalline sugar. This was apparently acquired while the delegation was at the Mahabodhi temple. A couple of Indian artisans and monks appear to have travelled back to Changan with the delegation.

Wang Xuance's mission to India in 647 CE was the last recorded diplomatic exchange between the two countries, and it did not end well. From fragmentary accounts left behind by Wang Xuance, it seems that his arrival coincided with a regional satrap trying to usurp Harsha's throne after his death and the ensuing political turmoil. Wang Xuance's delegation was attacked, and Wang Xuance escaped with some of the surviving members of his delegation to Tibet, which at that time was allied with the Tang empire. He gathered together soldiers from Tibet and from Nepal, which was then a vassal of Tibet, to attack and defeat the usurper and to take him as a captive to Changan. The captive was spared by the Tang emperor but lived out the rest of his days in China.

Wang Xuance also brought back to China with him an alchemist named Narayanswami from Magadha, who was renowned for making exotic potions to promote longevity. The ailing Tang emperor was reportedly taken in by this medicine man from India, who claimed to be 200 years old! The emperor did not get better and ordered that Narayanswami be sent back to India, but the fraudster died in Changan.